

Chapter 8: Electronic Presentations

8.1 What is meant by a 'presentation'?

People make presentations to share their views, opinions, ideas, and knowledge with a larger group. While traditional methods used tools like Overhead Projectors (OHP) and Slide Projectors, modern presentations use computer technology, video cameras, and multimedia projectors. A **multimedia electronic presentation** can include numbers, letters, pictures, graphics, videos, tables, graphs, voice, and sound.

8.2 Characteristics of a Good Quality Presentation

To convey a message clearly and keep the audience engaged, a presentation should adhere to these principles:

- **Number of lines:** The most appropriate number of lines per slide is 6-9. More lines make reading difficult and reduce font size.
- **Font-size:** It is an accepted norm to keep the font size at 32 points or more, depending on the distance between the screen and the audience.
- **Correct use of grammar and language:** Double-check grammar, spelling, and language carefully.
- **Inserting objects:** It is not suitable to insert more than two images, drawings, tables, or graphs per slide to avoid confusion.
- **Use of colours:** Pay attention to the contrast between background and foreground colors. Avoid using uncomfortable dark colors (like dark red) throughout the entire slide. Use bold colors only to emphasize certain points.
- **Animation and videos:** It is ideal to use one animation or video per slide to prevent overlapping sounds and viewer confusion.
- **Target group:** The content must meet the objectives of the target audience without diverting their attention with unnecessary animations or graphics.

8.3 Presentation Software

Software used to create multimedia presentations can be categorized into Proprietary (Commercial) and Free and Open Source Software (FOSS).

Software Name	Developing Organization	Type
Apple Keynote	Apple Inc.	Proprietary
Corel Presentation	Corel Corporation	Proprietary
Microsoft PowerPoint	Microsoft Corporation	Proprietary
LibreOffice Impress	Document Foundation	Open Source
OpenOffice.org Impress	Apache Corp.	Open Source

Cloud-based presentation tools like Office 365, Google Presentations, and Microsoft OneDrive PowerPoint can also be used without installing local software.

8.4 Fundamentals of Presentation Software

Key User Interface Components

- **Quick Access Toolbar:** Contains frequently used commands for fast execution.
- **Title Bar:** Displays the name of the open presentation and software.
- **Tabs / Ribbon:** Groups of commands represented by icons (e.g., Home, Insert, Design).
- **Slide Pane:** Vertical pane on the left showing mini versions (thumbnails) of slides.
- **Workspace:** The main area where the presentation slide is created and edited.
- **Notes Pane:** Used to insert speaker notes that are not visible to the audience during the show.
- **View Tab:** Allows switching between Normal View, Slide Sorter View, Reading View, and Slide Show.

View Types

- **Normal View:** The main editing interface.
- **Slide Sorter View:** Displays all slides as thumbnails to easily change their order.
- **Reading View:** Shows the slide clearly as it will appear on screen.
- **Slide Show:** Full-screen mode used to present to the audience (Shortcut: F5).

8.5 Creating and Formatting a Presentation

- **Slide Size & Orientation:** Can be adjusted (Portrait or Landscape) to suit the theme.
- **Themes & Layouts:** Software provides built-in templates (Office Themes / Master Pages) to apply consistent designs.
- **Adding Text:** Text is entered into "Placeholders" (e.g., 'Click to add title') or manually inserted Text Boxes.
- **Inserting Objects:** Shapes, Clip Art, and Pictures can be inserted, resized, and rotated.
- **Slide Transitions:** The animation effect applied when moving from one slide to the next. Transition speed, sounds, and triggers (mouse click or automatic) can be configured.
- **Custom Animations:** Effects applied to specific objects (text, images) within a single slide. Categories include Entrance, Emphasis, Exit, and Motion Paths.
- **Media:** Audio and Video files can be inserted from local storage or recorded directly.

8.6 Printing a Presentation

Presentations can be printed as Handouts. This allows the audience to receive a printed copy of the slides with space to write down important notes.

Summary

- Electronic presentations effectively replace manual ones using multimedia projectors.
- A good presentation has 6-9 lines per slide, readable fonts (32pt+), good color contrast, and minimal clutter.
- Software includes MS PowerPoint, LibreOffice Impress, and cloud-based tools.
- Features include applying themes, inserting multimedia (images, sound, video), animating objects, applying slide transitions, and printing handouts.